

POU11011 — Discussion points and tutorials

The 10% component · Michaelmas Term 2026

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The short version

Weight	10% of the module mark
What you submit	Two or three numbered discussion points, 200–400 words
How many times	Four — one before each tutorial
When	The evening before the tutorial, by 5pm
Where	The Discussion Points folder on Blackboard
Marked	Pass/fail. Two points per tutorial attended with an accepted submission, to a maximum of eight
The catch	You must submit <i>and</i> attend. Either one alone earns nothing

What to write

Two or three numbered points, 200–400 words in total.

You are not being asked for a polished analysis — you are being asked to raise something worth twenty minutes of argument.

Things that work:

- What the argument requires to be true.
- Where it fits the cases badly — name the case.
- Something in the news the reading explains, or fails to.
- Whether you believe it, and the alternative explanation.
- Two readings that disagree, and why.

Things that do not work: summarising the reading; three variations on “this was interesting”; a point that could have been written without opening the text.

Rough prose is fine.

The mechanics

Which tutorials. All four. Submit two or three numbered discussion points before each one.

Deadline: 5pm the evening before your tutorial meets. Late points are not accepted — not at 6pm, not the next morning, and never after the tutorial has met.

Marking. Pass/fail. Two points for each tutorial attended with an accepted submission, to a maximum of eight. Your TA can reject a submission that is too short or makes no genuine attempt at the reading.

The 80 cap. Departmental policy caps this component at 80. Eight points earns a mark of 80, with reductions proportional to that.

The Assignment Submission Form. Required as the first page of every discussion-points submission, same as the blog post and the final essay. A submission without one is not accepted.

Attendance

Attendance is compulsory and is half of this component: submitting without attending, or attending without submitting, earns nothing for that tutorial.

Excused absence (certified medical reasons only) requires your **College Tutor** to contact your TA and me. The credit procedure for an excused tutorial is in the [module outline](#).

Generative AI

Short version: don't.

Category	This component
Brainstorming	Not permitted. The point is that <i>you</i> had a reaction to the reading.
Research/learning assistance	Permitted, for one thing only: clarifying a term or passage you could not follow after genuinely trying — not for summarising the reading.
Writing assistance	Not permitted. These are short and ungraded on style; spellcheck is fine.
Direct AI content inclusion	Not permitted.

A rough, obviously human page is worth more here than a smooth one.

Dates

You do not sign up for a tutorial group: the department allocates you to one, and it appears in your my.tcd.ie timetable. Your four tutorial dates, times and rooms are confirmed there and on Blackboard.

Each submission is due at 5pm the evening before your own group meets, so the deadline depends on which group you are in.